



Loneliest kid in UK

This kid has moved reddit so much, hundreds of Christmas cards are coming his way. Oh internet! <http://dgit.in/SchoolBoyChristmasCards>



Fridge boats!

Rescuers in UK are using fridges to get people out of their small homes <http://dgit.in/FridgeAsLifeboat>

It's time for TED!

On the sidelines of the sixth successful edition of TEDxGateway, arguably India's largest, most high-profile independently organized TED event, we caught up with Jay Herratti, Executive Director, TEDx, to understand the platform's mission and reception in India, among other things. Excerpts:



Jay Herratti ▶
Executive Director, TEDx

Jayesh Shinde
jayesh.shinde@digit.in

d How does TEDx identify an idea that's worthy of spreading through the platform? Is there a mechanism in place to predict the impact an idea would have in general?

Herratti: We do that several ways, including posting some of the most compelling TEDx talks directly on <http://ted.com> or featuring them in playlists on the TEDx YouTube Channel. We also share daily stories on the TEDx Innovations blog. This gives us an opportunity to showcase the creative ways organizers around the world are hosting TEDx events in their local communities and spotlight some of our favourite talks.

d At TEDx, you are used to seeing a LOT of innovative ideas come your way. What fuels innovation? Necessity or curiosity?

Herratti: Necessity and curiosity are just two catalysts for innovation. By inviting speakers to focus on a single new idea in each talk, we are often more clearly able to see the essence of their innovation. I like to think that TEDx events celebrate human potential, and the ability to innovate is one of the things that makes us unique as humans.

d On TEDxWomen, what was the thought behind creating a forum exclusively for

women and how has the response been so far to this brand new format?

Herratti: TEDxWomen was imagined as a way to celebrate the women and girls shaping our future. We created a free TEDxWomen license so TEDx organizers can simultaneously host their own local events and tune into sessions from the main stage via livestream. In 2015, we had 238 TEDxWomen events take place across the globe in 68 countries.

d Can you share some insights into how India has responded to and consumed TEDx content?

Herratti: India is – and has always been – an important country for TEDx. There have been 563 TEDx events in India since 2009, with dozens more scheduled to take place in the first half of 2016 alone. We know from local TEDx organizers that their communities are hungry for great ideas. There's an entrepreneurial spirit in India that's fuelling this thirst for rapid innovation.

d From a layman's perspective, what are some of the biggest misconceptions about the TEDx platform?

Herratti: Many people think TEDx is just about the talks. And while the talks are a big part of spreading ideas – across borders, oceans and around the world – the real magic happens in the room at TEDx

events. It's about the serendipity of interaction that happens when people gather in one room and engage with each other. That's where visions are aligned and new ideas are born.

d What are some of the lesser-known facts about TEDx? Something that you can't find online?

Herratti: TEDx organizers around the world are themselves members of a global community of thousands. A big part of their experience is the bond they build with fellow organizers from other countries.

d Which talks are your all-time favorites?

Herratti: I can never answer this question. I have too many favourites. But two come to mind immediately: TED Prize winner Sugata Mitra's TED 2013 talk about building a school in the cloud and Dilip Ratha's TEDGlobal 2014 talk about international remittances – both are by speakers from India and both of these ideas impacted countless people's everyday lives. I also recently watched a TEDxGatewayWomen talk by Justice Leila Seth and was moved by her life story and insights.

To read the entire interview head over to : <http://dgit.in/Nv15bx> **d**